feel about Victoria and the boys. They're part of me.

Our family and the life that spins around us: sometimes we laugh and call it 'Bubble Beckham'. Victoria and I and Brooklyn and Romeo, at home, at the shops, on vacation: we're just a family that loves being together, doing what families do. Mum and Dad both have the kind of very public careers that mean our ordinary working days aren't very ordinary at all: me playing Champions League soccer in a packed stadium somewhere, with millions of people watching on television all over the world; Victoria cutting new tracks in a recording studio in New York; both of us jumping on a plane to go off and shoot a Japanese commercial on a beach in Thailand. And outside all of that, helping to keep the bubble bouncing along, is the fame thing: the attention, the gossip, the paparazzi and the stuff that's just made up—we know it is—but still comes with our names at the top of the page. Inside the bubble, we have family, friends and professionals who help us find a way through it all and we're grateful for that. I'm grateful we've got each other too. We've experienced some pretty weird things, along with what's been wonderful, since we've been together. It makes you strong knowing there's someone's hand you can hold. I know Victoria feels the same.

When I first met Mrs Beckham—Posh Spice—I'd never experienced the kind of hype, or the lifestyle, that came with being a massively successful pop star. Victoria was handling the situation long before I even knew what the situation was. Maybe my manager at Manchester United would have preferred me to have found a nice, quiet girl who'd stay indoors, clean the house, change diapers and have my dinner ready in the evening. Well, you can't choose who you fall in love with. When I met the girl of my dreams—the woman I always knew I was going to marry and settle down with—I was swept away by her. And, as I've said, part of the attraction was how good she was at what she did and how famous she was because of it. Because of where Victoria was in her life when I met her, and because of what's happened to me in my career in the last seven years, the fame thing has been on a steady upward curve ever since. Us being together, of course, has made it all even more intense.

The bubble seems to expand, almost day by day. Maybe the move to Madrid will change that: obviously, we'll try to keep our heads down and get on with starting what's bound to be a new adventure, settling in a new country, as well as at a new club. There's always a story, though, isn't there? And even if there's not, someone's ready to dream one up. Sometimes we wonder what would happen if it all just vanished overnight. We'd miss some of it but we'd still have the things that matter: each other and our children.